



TRAVEL AGENT

JOB DESCRIPTION

A travel agent organizes business or leisure travel for their customers. They may offer advice on national and international destinations, plan the trip itineraries, and take care of any ticket or passport issues that might arise. They may also make additional travel arrangements, including accommodation and restaurant or rental car bookings, and offer guidance on insurance, travel safety, vaccinations, and tours.



SALARY

Junior travel agent ★★★★★

Experienced travel agent ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Physical travel agencies facing growing competition from online travel sites • Providers that service a particular market, such as business travelers, remain in demand

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Travel and tourism • Geography • History • Business studies • Languages • Economics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A basic level of education is enough for entry-level jobs, but a degree in travel and tourism can be advantageous.



LIFESTYLE Travel agents work normal retail hours, including weekends. They may be expected to work overtime during high season.



LOCATION Travel agents usually work in an office or retail outlet. They sometimes get to travel to different destinations as part of their job.



THE REALITIES Agents may have to deal with unhappy customers, which can be challenging. They often have to explain situations beyond their control.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **HOTEL MANAGER** *see pp. 304–305*
- ▶ **AIRLINE CABIN CREW** *see pp. 308–309*
- ▶ **CUSTOMER SERVICE AGENT** Answers customer queries and deals with complaints. Customer service agents also take orders and payments, arrange refunds, and maintain computer records of transactions.
- ▶ **LEISURE CENTER MANAGER** Runs sports and recreation centers. The job involves arranging timetables for activities, supervising a range of staff, controlling budgets, and promoting and marketing the facilities on offer.
- ▶ **TOURIST INFORMATION ASSISTANT** Provides information about locations, facilities, and places open to visitors. Often based in airports and major railway stations, tourist information assistants use their knowledge of transportation schedules to advise visitors.